12.4.5 Scanning and filtering all of your table's data

John wants to know who else is using nodetodo and asks for a list of all users. You will learn how to list all items of a table without using an index next.

Sometime you can't work with keys because you don't know them up front; instead, you need to go through all the items in a table. That's not very efficient, but in rare situations, like daily batch jobs or rare requests, it's fine. DynamoDB provides the `scan` operation to scan all items in a table as shown next.

Listing 12.13 DynamoDB: Scan through all items in a table

```
const params = {
  TableName: 'app-entity',
  Limit: 50                                          ①
};
db.scan(params, (err, data) => {                     ②
  if (err) {
    console.error('error', err);
  } else {
    console.log('items', data.Items);
    if (data.LastEvaluatedKey !== undefined) {       ③
      console.log('more items available');
    }
  }
});
```

① Specifies the maximum number of items to return

② Invokes the scan operation on DynamoDB

③ Checks whether there are more items that can be scanned

The following listing shows how to scan through all items of the `todo-user` table. A paging mechanism is used to prevent too many items from being returned at a time.